UU-P-417c
August 24, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. UU-P-00417b (Army-GL)
January 25, 1965 and
Fed. Spec. UU-P-417a
September 9, 1952

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAPER, BLOTTING, PHOTOGRAPHIC PRINTS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers blotting paper intended for use in drying photographic prints.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grades.* Photographic blotting paper covered by this specification shall be furnished in the following grades as specified:

Grade A—50 percent rag.
Grade B—Chemical wood.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-31—Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
UU-T-111—Tape; Paper, Gummed (Sealing and Securing).
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following doc-

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uments form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Publication:

T 434 m 47—Acid-soluble Iron in Paper.

(Copies may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York 17, N. Y.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Grade A.* Grade A blotting paper shall contain not less than 50 percent rag, the remainder shall be free from unbleached and ground wood pulp when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.1.2 *Grade B.* When tested as specified in 4.3.2, grade B blotting paper shall contain not more than 10 percent ground wood pulp.

3.2 Size. Unless otherwise specified, blotting paper shall be furnished in sheets 24 by 30 inches with a tolerance of ± 1/8 inch (see 6.2). The sheets shall be considered square if the difference between diagonals does not exceed 1/8 inch.

3.3 Purity.

3.3.1 *Acidity.* When tested as specified in 4.3.2, the blotting paper shall have a minimum pH of 5 and a maximum pH of 7.

3.3.2 *Reaction with silver nitrate.* When tested as specified in 4.3.2, the blotting paper shall show no discoloration within one minute when treated with 0.1 ml. of 10 percent silver nitrate solution.

3.3.3 *Reaction with potassium permanganate.* When tested as specified in 4.3.2, the blotting paper shall not discharge the color of 0.1 ml. of 0.1 percent potassium permanganate in less than 15 seconds.

3.3.4 *Iron content.* When tested as specified in 4.3.2, the soluble iron content of the blotting paper shall not exceed 0.02 percent.

3.4 Color. The color of the blotting paper shall be essentially white and free from spots and inclusions. Paper whitening agents shall not affect the characteristics beyond the test limits described herein.

3.5 Physical requirements. When tested as specified in 4.3.2, the blotting paper shall conform to the requirements specified in table I.

TABLE I—*Physical requirements*

	Grade A	Grade B
Basis weight (19 by 24 inches—500 sheets) pounds[1]	140	120
Thickness, inch[2]	0.025	0.021
Bursting strength, points, minimum	30	23
Absorption time of 1.0 milliliters of water, seconds, maximum	60	60

[1] Tolerance—± 5 percent.
[2] Tolerance—± 0.002 inch.

3.6 Surface finish. The surface of the blotting paper shall be smooth, firm and free from loose materials such as fibers or lint that might be deposited on prints in service (see 6.3).

3.7 Workmanship. The blotting paper shall be clean and free from imperfections. Edges shall be smooth and clean-cut. The number of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality levels (AQLs) in section 4.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for

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the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 *Sampling for inspection.* Sampling for inspection and tests shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2 **Component and material inspection.** In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

4.3 **Inspection of the end item.**

4.3.1 *Examination of the end item.* The end item shall be examined in accordance with the defects set forth in the applicable subparagraphs at the inspection levels and AQLs in 4.3.1.4. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for examination of visual, dimensional, and preparation for delivery defects. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 12 sheet packages for examinations in 4.3.1.1 and 4.3.1.2 and in units of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot for examinations in 4.3.1.3.

4.3.1.1 *Examination for visual defects.* The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheet of blotting paper. Both sides of the material shall be examined. No more than one sample unit shall be selected from any one package and no more than three sample units from any one shipping container, when practicable. A defect of any type shall be counted only once in a sample unit.

Examine	Defect
Color	Not white.
Appearance	Presence of dirt, grease, foreign matter, or slime spots. Wrinkles, folds, holes, tears, cuts, or sharp creases. Surfaces not clean; not free from paper dust.
Workmanship	Edges not clean cut; any ragged, uneven, or crushed edge.

4.3.1.2. *Examination for dimensions.* The sample unit for this examination shall be one sheet of blotting paper. No more than one sample unit shall be selected from the same shipping container, when practicable.

Examine	Defect
Length and width	Varies from specified dimensions by more than ± 1/8 inch.
Squareness	Difference in length between two opposite corner diagonals exceeds 1/8 inch.

4.3.1.3 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination shall be made to determine that markings, materials, and workmanship comply with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. The lot shall be unacceptable if the average count per shipping container, selected for this examination, is less than specified or indicated. An equal number of shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects.

Examine	Defect
Markings	Incorrect; omitted; of improper size or location.
Materials	Any nonconforming component; component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components; such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose or inadequate sealing, strapping, or stapling. Bulged or distorted containers.

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4.3.1.4 *Inspection levels and AQLs for examination.* The inspection levels for determining the sample size and AQLs, expressed in defects per 100 sheets of blotting paper or 100 shipping containers, as applicable, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection levels	AQLs
4.3.1.1	I	6.5
4.3.1.2	S-2	2.5
4.3.1.3	S-2	2.5

4.3.2 *Testing of the end item.* The methods of testing specified in UU-P-31, where applicable, and as listed in table II, shall be followed. The test sample unit shall be the number of blotting sheets necessary to give at least a 1,000 square inch area. No more than one sample unit shall be taken from a shipping container, where practicable. The lot size for the purpose of determining the sample size shall be expressed in units of 12 sheet packages. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units of blotting paper packages, applicable to the individual unit. There shall be no failure to meet any test requirement applicable to the lot average. The composite shall be made up by combining small portions of approximately equal size from all sample units comprising the sample size.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Reaction with silver nitrate.* Drop 0.1 ml. of a solution containing 10 percent C.P. silver nitrate and 0.5 percent concentrated nitric acid on the surface of a specimen. Observe the specimen for 60 seconds. If no discoloration appears in this period of time, the sample shall be considered to have passed the test.

4.4.2 *Reaction with potassium permanganate.* Drop 0.1 ml. of a 0.1 percent potassium permanganate solution on the surface of a specimen. Observe the specimen for 15 seconds. If the color is not discharged in this period of time, the sample shall be considered to have passed the test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for

TABLE II—*Instructions for testing the end item*

Characteristic	Specification reference		Requirements applicable to		Number determinations per sample unit	Results reported as numerically to nearest[1]
	Requirement	Test method	Indiv. unit	Lot aver.		
Atmospheric conditions	4.3.2	102	All testing			
Fiber identification	3.1.1	300	—	—	1 on composite	5 percent
	3.1.2	300	—	—	1 on composite	5 percent
Basis weight, pounds	Table I	110	—	X	1 (on 1000 sq. in. specimen)	pound
Thickness, inches	Table I	173	—	X	10	0.0001 inch
Bursting strength, points	Table I	112	—	X	10 (5 on each side)	point
Absorption, seconds	Table I	180	X	—	10	second
Acidity, pH units	3.3.1	200	—	—	Average of 2 on composite	0.1 pH units
Reaction with silver nitrate	3.3.2	4.4.1	X	—	1	second
Reaction with potassium permanganate	3.3.3	4.4.2	X	—	1	second
Iron content	3.3.4	T434m47[2]	—	—	Average of 2 on composite	0.005 percent

[1] Test reports shall include all values on which results are based.

[2] Indicates Standard of the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry.

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definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing for civil agency procurements.

5.1 **Packaging.** Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Twelve sheets of blotting paper, of one grade only, shall be completely wrapped in kraft paper having a minimum basis weight of 30 pounds per ream (24 by 36—500). The wrapping shall be sealed with an adhesive or gummed paper tape. Adhesive, when used, shall be applied in such a manner that contact will not be made with the adhesive and the paper being packed.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The blotting paper shall be packaged in accordance with the industry's practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* One hundred and forty-four sheets of blotting paper, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style FTC, V3c of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* One hundred and forty-four sheets of blotting paper, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style FTC, type CF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification, for weather-resistant boxes, except that tape conforming to class 3 of UU-T-111 shall be used.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Blotting paper, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. St. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** Blotting paper covered by this specification is intended for use in drying photographic prints.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Grade, quantity, and size required (see 1.2.1 and 3.2).
(*c*) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 **Lint.** The term linting as applied to blotting paper should not be taken in the absolute sense. In general, the amount of lint found on prints dried between blotting paper can be correlated with the hardness or stickiness of the emulsion layer. Prints fixed in a good acid hardening fixing bath will show a small amount of lint which can be removed by rubbing with a soft cloth. Glossy prints will pick up more than matte or semi-matte prints. A method for evaluating the linting properties of blotting paper appears not to have been developed, however, comparisons between blotting paper

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of different makes can be estimated visually.

6.4 **Transportation description.** Transportation description and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Paper, blotting.
Carload minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

Motor:

Paper, blotting.
Truckload minimum weight 36,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL
Navy—WP
Air Force—69

Review activities:

Army—GL

Navy—WP

Air Force—69

User activities:

Army—EL

Navy—MC

Preparing activity:

Army—GL

Review and user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing Of DOD Standardization Documents.

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